



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

WHY HAS PEACE PROVED SO ELUSIVE IN THE MIDDLE EAST?

*Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995 -
Key Topic 2: The escalating conflict, 1964-73*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade	9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT 2.1: The Six Day War, June 1967			
L2: KT 2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War & The Rise of Palestinian Resistance			
L3: KT 2.3: Israel and Egypt: The War of Attrition and the Yom Kippur War, 1967–1973			
Final Unit Grade:			

L1: KT 2.1: The Six Day War, June 1967

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the significance of the Cairo Conference (1964) and the growth of Fatah and the PLO.
- ☐ Analyze the escalating tension between Israel, Syria and Jordan: Syria's support for Fatah, Israel's raid on Samu and the events of 7 April 1967.
- ☐ Evaluate the actions of the USSR, Nasser and the USA in the period leading to war, and the key events of the war.

Q1. Source Detective: What does this iconic photograph reveal about the emotional and religious significance of capturing East Jerusalem for Israeli soldiers, and how did this victory transform Jerusalem into a central focus of the ongoing conflict?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Who became President of Egypt in 1954 and emerged as the champion of Pan-Arab nationalism?

What vital waterway did Nasser nationalise on 26 July 1956, triggering an international invasion?

Which three nations secretly colluded at Sèvres in October 1956 to attack Egypt?

Why was Britain and France forced to halt their military operation in Egypt in November 1956?

What international peacekeeping body was stationed in Sinai and Sharm el-Sheikh following the 1956 war?

What was the political union formed between Egypt and Syria in 1958 called?

What Palestinian organisation was officially created at the Cairo Conference in 1964?

What narrow maritime strait controls Israel's maritime access from Eilat to the Red Sea?

What freshwater dispute escalated border clashes between Israel and Syria in the mid-1960s?

Which global superpower became the primary military supplier and patron of Egypt and Syria by the 1960s?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

PLO (Palestine Liberation Organisation) Fatah Pre-emptive Strike Casus Belli

In the 1960s, Palestinian nationalism grew stronger with the creation of the [.], an umbrella organization, and its dominant guerrilla faction, [.]. Border tensions flared violently when Israel launched the [.] into the West Bank in 1966. These escalating events eventually culminated in June 1967 when Israel launched [.], a devastating pre-emptive air strike that wiped out the Arab air forces on the ground.

Q2. What was the primary objective of the Palestine Liberation Organisation (PLO) when it was established at the 1964 Cairo Conference?

Q3. How did the dispute over the River Jordan escalate tensions between Israel and the Arab states in the mid-1960s?

Q4. How did the new Syrian government support the Fatah guerrilla movement from 1966 onwards?

Q5. Source Detective: Why did capturing the Old City of Jerusalem carry such immense religious and political significance for Israel?

Q6. What was the outcome of the April 1967 air clash over Damascus, and how did it affect the Syrian leadership?

Q7. How did the Soviet Union's misinformation in May 1967 act as a catalyst for the crisis?

Q8. Identify two dangerous gambles President Nasser took between 15 May and 23 May 1967.

Q9. Describe the success of Operation Focus launched by the Israeli air force on 5 June 1967.

Q10. What were the key territorial conquests of the Israeli Defence Forces during the land war?

Q11. Summarise the key steps taken by Egypt in May 1967 that convinced Israel that war was imminent.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q12. Was Israel justified in launching Operation Focus on 5 June 1967? Explain one reason supporting Israel's decision, and one reason criticising it.

Guidance: Consider Nasser's provocative actions in May 1967 (closing the Straits of Tiran and ordering UN peacekeepers out) versus the fact that Israel struck first and destroyed Egypt's air force before any Arab invasion began.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- Israel argued the pre-emptive strike was justified self-defence because...
- On the other hand, Arab states argued Israel was guilty of unprovoked aggression because...

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q13. Explain one consequence of Egypt closing the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping in May 1967.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STEP PEE FORMULA (POINT, EVIDENCE, EXPLANATION)

EDEXCEL PAPER
2

Write exactly 1 focused analytical paragraph (approx. 5 minutes). Do NOT write an introduction, conclusion, or a second consequence.

[P] Point (Consequence): State ONE clear, valid consequence of the Israeli preemptive airstrike in Operation Focus (5 June 1967) directly addressing the military outcome of the Six Day War.

[E] Evidence (Contextual Detail): Deploy precise historical facts (names, dates, treaties, or figures) from June 1967 to prove what happened.

[E] Explanation (Causal Impact): Explain the lasting causal effect on Arab-Jewish relations or regional geopolitics using causal connectives.

Sentence Starters:

- "One consequence of the Israeli preemptive airstrike in Operation Focus (5 June 1967) was the total destruction of Arab air power, securing absolute Israeli air supremacy that guaranteed rapid victory."
- "For example, in the opening three hours of the war, the Israeli Air Force (IAF) wiped out over 300 Egyptian combat aircraft on the tarmac and cratered their runways, followed by the destruction of the Syrian and Jordanian air forces."
- "As a direct result of operating with zero aerial opposition, Israeli ground armour was able to advance with complete impunity across the Sinai Peninsula, West Bank, and Golan Heights, consequently achieving total military victory in just six days."

Causal Connectives: As a direct result • Consequently • This led directly to • Because of this • This meant that • Crucially

EXIT TICKET: SPLIT-PERSPECTIVE FRONT PAGE

EXIT TICKET • SPLIT-PERSPECTIVE HEADLINES

Write two punchy, **6-word newspaper headlines** capturing the historic shock of the Six-Day War (10 June 1967):

- Headline A (Israeli Perspective - The Jerusalem Post): Summarize the capture of the Old City and new defensive depth.
- Headline B (Arab Perspective - Al-Ahram, Cairo): Summarize the shock of the "Naksa" (Setback) and loss of Sinai and Jerusalem.

Teacher Guidance: Strict constraint: Exactly 6 words per headline! Ensure each captures the emotional and geopolitical reality of each side.

Pupil Response:

L2: KT 2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War & The Rise of Palestinian Resistance

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand UN Resolution 242 and the continued dispute over the Suez Canal.
- ☐ Analyze the situation of Palestinian refugees and the significance of the occupied territories: Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank, Sinai and East Jerusalem.
- ☐ Evaluate the use of terrorism, Israel's response and international attitudes towards the Palestine issue: the PFLP airplane hijacks of 1970; Black September and the Munich Olympics; and the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan (1970).

Q1. Source Detective: Why did radical Palestinian militant groups shift toward dramatic international terrorism like the Munich Olympics hostage crisis after the total defeat of conventional Arab armies in the 1967 Six-Day War?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the codename of the surprise Israeli air strike that launched the Six Day War on 5 June 1967?

Approximately how many Egyptian combat aircraft were destroyed on the ground within the first three hours?

Which four major territories did Israel capture and occupy during the Six Day War?

From which country did Israel capture the West Bank and the Old City of Jerusalem in 1967?

From which country did Israel capture the Golan Heights in 1967?

From which country did Israel capture the Sinai Peninsula and Gaza Strip in 1967?

What landmark United Nations Security Council Resolution was passed in November 1967 establishing the "land for peace" formula?

What were the "Three No's" agreed by Arab leaders at the Khartoum Summit in August 1967?

Who was Israel's Minister of Defense during the Six Day War who became an international icon of victory?

What Egyptian waterway was closed to international shipping from 1967 to 1975 due to sunken ships and Israeli occupation of its east bank?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

UN Resolution 242 Khartoum Resolution PFLP Black September Operation Wrath of God
--

Your Sentence:

Q2. Source Detective: How did the live global media coverage of the Munich hostage crisis change international awareness of the Palestinian cause?

Q3. How did Israel and the Arab states interpret the ambiguous wording of UN Resolution 242 differently?

Q4. What was the defiant response of the Arab states at the August 1967 Arab League Summit in Khartoum?

Q5. Explain the strategic significance of the captured territories for Israel's military security.

Q6. How did the Israeli policy of building Jewish settlements in the occupied territories impact the local Arab population?

Q7. Source Detective: What message was Yasser Arafat conveying to world leaders by offering an "olive branch" while warning them not to let it fall from his hand?

Q8. Why did the Popular Front for the Liberation of Palestine (PFLP) hijack commercial airliners to Dawson's Field in 1970?

Q9. Source Detective: Study the map. Why did the armed Fedayeen presence in Jordanian capital cities directly threaten the survival and sovereignty of King Hussein's Hashemite monarchy?

Q10. Why did King Hussein of Jordan view the PLO as a threat to his sovereignty by 1970?

Q11. What was the outcome of the 'Black September' civil war in Jordan in 1970?

Q12. Source Detective: How did global television coverage of the Munich massacre impact international attitudes toward the Palestinian cause?

Q13. Describe the events and consequences of the 1972 Munich Olympic Games terrorist attack.

Q14. Explain how the expulsion of the PLO from Jordan in 1970 led to the emergence of international terrorism like the 1972 Munich Olympics attack.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q15. Explain two reasons why Israel's victory in 1967 created new obstacles to peace.

Guidance: Focus on the reaction of Arab leaders at the Khartoum Summit ('Three No's') and why Palestinians turned to independent armed struggle under the PLO rather than trusting Arab armies.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- Firstly, peace became harder because Arab leaders at Khartoum declared...
- Secondly, peace was blocked because the Palestinian PLO decided that...

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q16. Write a narrative account analysing the escalation of Palestinian armed resistance and militant tactics in the years 1968–1972. You may use the following in your answer: • The Battle of Karameh (1968) • Black September in Jordan (1970) You must also use information of your own.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

**EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 3-STAGE CHRONOLOGICAL LINKAGE CHAIN
(BEGINNING → MIDDLE → END)**

EDEXCEL
PAPER 2

Write exactly 3 logically connected chronological paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). You **MUST** use both stimulus points **PLUS** at least one development from your own knowledge. Show **HOW** each event directly triggered the next.

[1] The Beginning (Catalyst & Origin): Explain how the territorial losses of the 1967 Six Day War led to the rise of independent fedayeen guerrilla warfare and the Battle of Karameh (1968) (Stimulus: 1967 War aftermath).

[2] The Middle (Causal Turning Point): Explain the decisive turning point of Black September (1970) in Jordan, the expulsion to Lebanon, and the shift toward international terrorism like the Munich Olympics massacre (1972) (Own Knowledge).

[3] The End (Culmination & Resolution): Explain the culmination: international recognition of the PLO as the 'sole legitimate representative of the Palestinian people' at the Rabat Summit and Arafat's landmark UN address in 1974 (Stimulus: Arafat UN Speech).

Sentence Starters:

- "The growth of independent Palestinian resistance was initiated following the Arab defeat in the 1967 Six Day War, which convinced Palestinians that conventional Arab armies could not liberate their homeland."
- "A decisive turning point occurred in September 1970 ('Black September') when King Hussein of Jordan crushed and expelled the heavily armed PLO militias, which consequently drove extremist factions like Black September to adopt spectacular international terror tactics, culminating in the 1972 Munich Olympics massacre."
- "This cycle of armed resistance and international notoriety culminated in November 1974 when Yasser Arafat was invited to address the UN General Assembly in New York, securing global diplomatic legitimacy for the PLO while presenting his famous choice between 'an olive branch and a freedom fighter's gun'."

Causal Connectives: The crisis was initiated when • This directly triggered • A decisive turning point occurred when • Consequently • As a direct consequence • This situation culminated in

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Stimulus Point 1

The Battle of Karameh (1968)

Stimulus Point 2

Black September in Jordan (1970)

EXIT TICKET: THE 3-MINUTE PAPER 2 SPEED-RUN

EXIT TICKET · PAPER 2 MICRO-DRILL

In Edexcel Paper 2, Question 1 is **always** a 4-mark question: "*Explain one consequence of...*" Spend 3 minutes writing a single PEEL paragraph for today's topic:

- Question: Explain one consequence of the Battle of Karameh (1968) for the Palestinian resistance movement.
- Structure Requirement: State your Point (1 mark), provide specific historical Evidence [e.g. Fatah recruitment, Arafat prestige] (1 mark), and Explain the consequence (2 marks).

Teacher Guidance: Write with precision. Avoid generic fluff.

Pupil Response:

L3: KT 2.3: Israel and Egypt: The War of Attrition and the Yom Kippur War, 1967–1973

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze Egyptian relations with Israel, the USA, the USSR and other Arab states.
- ☐ Understand Israel's consolidation of control of the occupied territories.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Yom Kippur War (1973) and its aftermath.

Q1. How did the Egyptian surprise assault on Yom Kippur completely undermine Israeli intelligence and defensive assumptions?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the massive sand-wall fortification line built by Israel along the eastern bank of the Suez Canal after 1967 called?

Who became Chairman of the Palestine Liberation Organization (PLO) in 1969?

What country expelled the PLO in September 1970 after international airline hijackings?

What tragic terrorist attack carried out by Black September in 1972 resulted in the murder of 11 Israeli athletes?

What country became the new base of operations for the PLO after their expulsion from Jordan in 1970?

Who succeeded Gamal Abdel Nasser as President of Egypt following Nasser's death in September 1970?

What was the undeclared artillery and air duel fought between Egypt and Israel along the Suez Canal from 1968 to 1970 called?

What formula was established by UN Resolution 242 demanding Israeli withdrawal in exchange for peace?

What did the Arab Khartoum Resolution mean by the "Three No's"?

What strategic plateau did Israel capture from Syria in 1967 that protected northern Galilee?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **War of Attrition**

Q2. How did Israel respond to Nasser's artillery bombardments during the War of Attrition, and what was Nasser's reaction?

Q3. Why did believe he desperately needed to secure the return of the Sinai Peninsula?

Q4. What was the 'Peace for Sinai' offer proposed by Anwar Sadat, and why did Golda Meir reject it?

Q5. Source Detective: What does this photograph reveal about the indispensable role of US presidential diplomacy in brokering peace between Israel and Egypt?

Q6. Why did Sadat expel 15,000 Soviet advisers from Egypt in July 1972, and what was the US reaction?

Q7. What was the Bar Lev Line, and what was its purpose?

Q8. Source Detective: Study the Egyptian crossing points along the Suez Canal. How did Egyptian forces use the water barrier and geographical depth of the Sinai passes to catch the Israeli Bar Lev line by surprise?

Q9. Source Detective: How did Egypt use innovative engineering to overcome Israel's formidable sand fortifications?

Q10. How did the Egyptian army successfully breach the Bar Lev Line at the start of the Yom Kippur War?

Q11. Describe the superpower proxy conflict that emerged during the Yom Kippur War.

Q12. How did the Arab members of OPEC attempt to force the United States to restrain Israel?

Q13. Explain why both Israel and Egypt viewed the outcome of the 1973 Yom Kippur War with mixed feelings.



WRITTEN CONSOLIDATION & RECALL

Recall & Analysis

Q14. How did the 1973 Yom Kippur War change the confidence and attitudes of both Egypt and Israel?

Guidance: Consider why crossing the Bar-Lev line restored Egyptian honour and pride, and why the surprise attack shattered Israel's belief that it was invincible.

SENTENCE STARTERS:

- For Egypt and the Arab world, the war restored pride and confidence because...
- For Israel, the surprise attack shattered their sense of security because...

Pupil Response:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q15. Explain the importance of the 1973 Yom Kippur War for relations between the superpowers (the USA and the Soviet Union).

[8 marks • 10 mins]

EXAM STRUCTURE STRIP: THE 'X LINKED TO Y' SIGNIFICANCE FRAMEWORK (2 FOCUSED PEEL PARAGRAPHS)

EDEXCEL
PAPER 2

Write exactly 2 analytical PEEL paragraphs (approx. 10–12 minutes). Divide your analysis into (1) Immediate / Short-Term Importance and (2) Long-Term / Strategic Significance. Always explain the difference the Yom Kippur War (October 1973) made for Arab-Israeli diplomacy and military perceptions.

[P1] Immediate / Short-Term Importance: Explain how Egypt's successful initial crossing of the Suez Canal (Operation Badr) shattered the myth of Israeli invincibility and restored Egyptian national honour.

[P2] Long-Term / Strategic Transformation: Explain how the OPEC oil embargo and superpower nuclear alert convinced the United States (via Henry Kissinger) that Middle Eastern peace was an urgent global priority, paving the way for Camp David.

Sentence Starters:

- "In the short term, the Yom Kippur War was of decisive importance because it shattered the dangerous Israeli myth of invincibility and restored Egyptian military honour following the humiliation of 1967."
- "This was demonstrated when Egyptian forces successfully crossed the Suez Canal under Operation Badr on 6 October 1973, breaching the heavily fortified Bar-Lev Line and inflicting catastrophic early casualties on Israeli armour using Soviet-supplied Sagger missiles."
- "In the long term, the war fundamentally transformed Middle Eastern diplomacy by convincing both Washington and Jerusalem that military occupation alone could not guarantee Israeli security."

Causal Connectives: In the short term, the Yom Kippur War (October 1973) was of decisive importance for Arab-Israeli diplomacy and military perceptions because • This was demonstrated when • In the long term, this fundamentally altered • Crucially, the strategic impact was that • Ultimately, the significance of the Yom Kippur War (October 1973) for Arab-Israeli diplomacy and military perceptions was that

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EXIT TICKET: THE THREE-TIERED GOLDEN SENTENCE

EXIT TICKET • THE GOLDEN SENTENCE

Write **ONE single, grammatically sophisticated historical sentence** explaining why Anwar Sadat signed the 1979 Egypt-Israel Peace Treaty. Must contain all 3 required ingredients:

- **Ingredient 1 (Date / Stat):** Include one date or statistic [e.g., October 1973, 1978, 13 days at Camp David, or the return of the entire Sinai Peninsula].
- **Ingredient 2 (Individual / Leader):** Name one leader [e.g., Anwar Sadat, Menachem Begin, or Jimmy Carter].
- **Ingredient 3 (Causal Conjunction):** Connect your reasoning with an analytical conjunction [e.g., in order to, resulting in, despite, or whereby].

Teacher Guidance: Focus on the trade-off: recovering Egyptian land in exchange for peace and diplomatic isolation from the Arab League.

Pupil Response:

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

GCSE Exam Practice: Question Bank

Choose an exam question from the bank below and answer it on the blank lined pages that follow.

From KT 2.1: The Six Day War, June 1967

1. Explain one consequence of Egypt closing the Straits of Tiran to Israeli shipping in May 1967.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

From KT 2.2: The Aftermath of the 1967 War & The Rise of Palestinian Resistance

1. Write a narrative account analysing the escalation of Palestinian armed resistance and militant tactics in the years 1968–1972. You may use the following in your answer: • The Battle of Karameh (1968) • Black September in Jordan (1970) You must also use information of your own.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

From KT 2.3: Israel and Egypt: The War of Attrition and the Yom Kippur War, 1967–1973

1. Explain the importance of the 1973 Yom Kippur War for relations between the superpowers (the USA and the Soviet Union).

[8 marks • 10 mins]

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